

Piggy Boy

© Osher Volotker, 2025. All rights reserved.

No part of this story may be reproduced, distributed, or used without the author's written permission.

The day begins as the sun rises, clear skies letting the sun shine its yellow, bright, warm rays over a southern country farm. A boy named Cody slowly opens his eyes as the light warms his face. The gentle warmth streams through his body. The air is filled with the smell of grass, hay, and cow poo.

Cody is 8 years old. He lives with his parents. Cody is home-schooled. Cody is an only child. Cody enjoys helping around the farm, especially with the animals. On the farm, they have cows, chickens, goats, and a few horses for transportation. The family also has a dog named Max. Max is a guard dog, but he also likes to play with Cody sometimes.

Cody got ready and went outside to begin the day. Cody was playing with a baby chick. He was feeding it and playing ball with it. But the rubber ball was too big for the baby chick; it could not grab it or move it around. Cody still had a great time; he loved being around the animals. But his parents did not allow him to stay there for too long. After his duties were done, Cody was sent back to the house to either study or play with Max. Cody didn't like that; he wanted to spend more time with the animals. Why shouldn't he? They were fun to play with, and their fur is soft and fluffy. Well, not for everyone. The calf skin is too bristly, coarse, but it has some smoothness in it. Cody loves all animals. It didn't matter how their fur felt to his touch; he just loved being around them so much.

Cody's mother was finishing up nursing a lamb, so she sent Cody to fetch some water from the back of the house. This will be used to keep the animals hydrated for the night.

Cody went to the back with a bucket and started to fill it when suddenly..... a noise! Cody stopped the water. Drip..... Drip..... Drip. The last drops fell into the bucket.

Then... quiet.

"What was that?" he whispered.

"Maybe it was the wind. Maybe it was a monster! No, not a monster." Cody questioned.

Then THUD! THUD! THUD! Loud noises came from the shed.

"Dad? Is that you?"

No answer. Only the wind said whoosh.

He went to check it out. When he reached the shed door, he slowly opened it, and then it went whoosh open quickly; something ran out from there fast.

Cody yelped and fell backward.

SPLAT! Cody fell in the mud.

Cody froze for a moment, then he looked at his clothes. Mud on his shirt, mud on his shoes, even a big brown spot on his nose! Cody looked at himself.

“I’m the mud monster now!” He giggled.

He then hears a noise, “Oink Oink!” It was a little piglet. A tiny pink ball of wiggles scooted under the house. Covered with mud smudges.

Cody got up and got closer.

“Hey! Don’t be afraid. Come out.” Cody said gently with a soft voice.

Cody approached the little piggy slowly; the piglet was frozen in its place, frightened. Cody’s heart went thump-thump-thump. He slowly extends his hand to pet the little piggy, and as his hand touches his skin, he feels the Cloddy mud on it. He slowly pets the piglet's head and lets it come out from its hiding spot. Cody likes the little piggy; he was naughty, just like him sometimes. Cody wants to wash the dirt off and clean the little piggy. Then bring it inside the house.

“You’re a muddy mess,” Cody giggled.

“Let’s make you shiny!”

He turned on the hose- sprish-splash-sploosh!

The piggy squealed with joy, dancing in the water. Cody thought the little piggy was special. The farm does not have pigs in it. Cody never saw one. When Cody looks deep into the eye of the little piglet, he knows..... They're gonna be best friends forever.

Cody wasn't sure how the little piglet got inside the shed. When he went to check it out, he saw a hole being dug; it was small but quite deep. This is how the piglet probably got in.

Cody covered it up so his parents won't find the hole. Using his bare hands, he started dragging the sandy mud to cover the hole.

Cody went inside the house. He washed his hands and grabbed some food for the piglet. He went back to the shed, knelt, and placed a few fruits on the ground.

"I like you, little one," Cody said softly.

"I'm gonna call you Pinky."

Cody tried to lead Pinky into the house, but Pinky seemed too scared to go in.

"Come, Pinky. It's okay."

Cody couldn't get Pinky to move, so he grabbed him and tried to pick him up.

Pinky was heavy but also started to go wild; he thrashed around wildly in Cody's arms. Cody tries to calm Pinky down, but with no success. He eventually let him go.

"Okay, Okay. Calm down. We won't go inside." Cody said, his words quick and tight.

Cody decided to bring Pinky to the stables. There he found an empty pen of a horse that was sold a while ago. Pinky can stay there, it's nice and there is a big space for him.

Cody wanted to tell his parents right away, but Pinky is scared, he should wait until Pinky feels better. After all, Pinky seemed very stressed to get into the house. Cody set up a nice hiding spot for Pinky in the pen. He took a stack of hay and placed it to be tall and huge like a mountain. Pinky could sleep inside of it and be hidden.

"There you go, your own palace" Cody giggles.

"This should be fine. I'll come back tomorrow and bring you more food, okay?"

Cody is about to leave. He stops in his step, and turns to look at Pinky one last time.

“Sleep well, Pinky.”

The next morning, Cody wakes up very excited. He rushes to the bathroom and brushes his teeth quickly. His mother comes in to check up on him, and she is surprised.

“Cody never rushes to brush his teeth so quickly in the morning. What got him so rushed?” she thought to herself.

“Cody, what’s the rush?”

“I’m....I just wanna go play with the animals already, mother.” Cody responded joyfully.

“huh.....I see” his mother chuckles.

Cody finishes up and rushes to the kitchen.

“Cody, not so fast....”

Cody went to the kitchen. In there, he went for the basket of fruits and took a few apples out of it. He then reached for the grapes in the fridge and took some out. He put all of it inside his pack.

His father comes down with his mother, and Cody sits at the table like a good-mannered boy.

“Cody! You're up early,” his dad called out.

“Something got him very excited today,” his mother whispered to his father.

His mother went to Cody and kissed him on the cheek, and then went to make breakfast. His father sat down next to Cody and started to read the newspaper.

After a few minutes of breakfast being made, Cody seems uneasy in his seat, like he has spikes on his seat. Moving left and right like a swing.

His father noticed it. "Is everything alright, Cody?"

"Yes! I'm fine, Dad!" he answered rashly.

"You look impatient, son. Is something wrong?" his father leans over from his seat.

"I'm just so hungry, Dad. MOM! When is breakfast ready!?" he called out in a loud voice.

"Almost, baby!"

Breakfast was ready, everyone sat down around the table, and started to eat. There were a lot of good things on the table. Scramble eggs, toast, pancakes, and orange juice. Cody had 2 pancakes on his plate, and he silently slipped one into his pack right next to him. He finished the rest quickly so he could leave the table.

"Wow, Cody, you finished so fast!" his mother said, her eyes wide with surprise.

"Yes! Mom! Thanks. Your breakfast is the best!"

"Okay, I'm going outside, bye." Cody responded rashly while getting ready to leave.

Both his parents looked at each other as Cody left the room. They both had this strange look of something is off, but they thought it was nothing.

"Kids are kids." They thought to themselves.

Cody rushed to the stables fast, running till his lungs were out of breath. He stopped at the door to catch his breath before entering.

"Pinky! I've come back, and I brought good things for you." Cody called out.

“Oink! Oink!” Pinky squealed.

Cody got to the pen, Pinky crawled out of the hay, and reached for him. They both rejoiced together, but Pinky seemed more interested in the pack rather than Cody.

Cody laughed, “OH! You want what’s inside my pack?!”

“I got some good food for you here!”

Cody starts to take out the food from the pack and place it on the ground. Pinky quickly goes for the pancake.

“You like the pancake more? Okay, I shall bring more of those next time.” Cody said joyfully.

Pinky ate the food Cody brought to him, while Cody sat there and watched him, sometimes reaching out and petting his soft skin.

“You are very pretty, Pinky! I never saw an animal with your colors. You must be a magical animal,” Cody said happily.

“Oink! Oink!” Pinky squealed.

“I have to go help my parents, but I will be back when I can. Stay here.”

Cody stood up. “Go back inside, Pinky. Don’t let mum and dad see you.” Cody whispered.

Cody then left the stables.

He went to the cows' pens to help his parents with today’s tasks. When he got there, he saw his mother already feeding the cows, and he rushed towards her.

“Cody! Where have you been?”

“I just went to play with the little goats.”

“I checked the goats' pen, you weren't there.”

“huh..... You may have missed me. I went to the bathroom to clean up.” he said nervously.

His mother looks at him suspiciously for a while. “Okay... Come help me.” his mother said softly.

Cody quickly gets to work. He fills the feeding trough for the cows. He makes his way from one end to the other. It is hard work for Cody, but Cody enjoys it.

After a few hours of helping around and playing with the animals, it's lunch time. Cody rushes to the house and takes some more fruits from the basket. This time, he even took a piece of cheese from the fridge. He sliced a small piece of it and put it inside his pack.

He then rushes quickly to the stables before his parents come back, and he goes into Pinky's pen and puts the food down. Pinky comes out squealing.

“Here, Pinky! I got you some more food.”

“There is even cheese in it, too. Do you like cheese?”

“Cody! Cody! Where are you?” his dad shouted.

Cody has no time to stay. He has to go back to the house.

“I've got to go, Pinky.” Cody said quickly.

“But don't worry. I'll be back later.” Cody said, his voice a little rushed.

Cody left in a hurry and closed the stables door fast. His dad saw him.

“Cody! What were you doing in the stables?!”

“Just checking on the horses dad!” Cody responded nervously.

“Well, come back into the house. Get yourself cleaned up, lunch is almost ready.”

Cody went to the house and cleaned himself up, then he went downstairs and sat at the table. His mother at the kitchen finishing up lunch, and his dad is outside finishing up his tasks. Cody sits still, like a good boy, not moving an inch, it's almost like his a professional man-statue. His mother glances at him sometimes.

“Cody! Is everything okay?”

“Yes, mother!”

She is concerned his father might have said something to him that could have made him behave that way.

“Did your father say anything to you? Did he do anything?” "she asked, concerned."

“No, mum. I'm just waiting for your delicious food.” Cody responded with confidence and a smile.

“Okay..... you're just acting weird all day, baby!” His mother sighs.

“I'm great, Mum. Everything is perfect.” he smiles.

They all sit down and eat a nice lunch together. His mother cooked chicken today. Cody loves chicken. Cody slipped more food into his pack unnoticed. After lunch, it's time for studies. Cody goes to his room and gets his notebooks ready; his mother is coming to teach him new things today.

“Oh boy! What will we learn today?” Cody thought to himself, excited.

But he had to go check on Pinky and bring him food and a blanket. Cody leaned over the door and peeked to see if his mother was coming; she wasn't. He slowly walks over to the front door, looking over to the kitchen, his mother is still doing the dishes, so his got time. He quietly opened the door and got out, and then ran towards the stables. He entered and came to Pinky.

“Hey Pinky! I missed you.” he said, full of excitement.

“I brought some very good food for you. I got chicken. I love chicken. I’m sure you would love it too.”

He placed the food on the ground and stayed a bit with Pinky. This time, he tried to feed him. He took a piece of chicken in his hand and let Pinky get closer to him. Pinky was quite the hungry type; he wanted that piece. Pinky started climbing onto Cody and made him lose his balance and fall to the ground.

“Easy there. I know you're so hungry.” he said, laughing.

Pinky started to snuggle with Cody, his nose tickles Cody's face. Cody bursts out laughing, unable to contain himself. He wraps his arms around Pinky's head and closely hugs him. This was special. Cody felt something magical happening between them. That feeling made him so happy.

“Cody! Cody!” his mother called him.

Cody was lost in a moment of happiness. Like nothing else existed. But he quickly regained his senses. Now he could hear his mother calling for him.

“I must go now. I will be back tomorrow.”

“I can’t come tonight after dinner, my parents won’t allow me to leave the house.” Cody said with sad eyes.

Cody placed the blanket inside the hay so Pinky could have warmth in the night. He then got out of the stable and went back to the house.

“Cody! Where have you been? Are you trying to avoid your studies?” his mother said with a serious tone.

“No, mother! I was just checking something outside.....I.....I thought I lost something in the cow pens,” he said hesitantly, looking at the ground.

Cody is acting very strange, but his mother doesn't think much of it, so they get started with his lessons. Today it's English. Cody loved English. He could spell out animal names and even mimic their voices.

"MOO!"

Said the cow Cody mimicked.

"Cluck!, cluck!" Said the Chicken Cody mimicked.

"Arf! Arf!" Said the dog Cody mimicked.

Cody got curious and asked this next....

"Mum, what is an animal in pink color?" Cody asked.

"Oh, you mean Flamingos. They have a pink color,"

"What sound do they make?" Cody curiously asked.

"They do Honk! Honk!" his mother mimicked.

"Ha, no, that's not the one."

"Not the one? What do you mean, Cody?" his mother asked, confused.

"Are there more pink colors animals?"

"Yes, there are more. Would you like to learn about pink colored animals?" his mother asked while smiling.

"YES! I do!" Cody said, bursting with excitement.

“Okay then. The Flamingos are like a bird, with wings, they are very tall and have a beautiful pink color on their body.” his mother explained.

“Then we have the Octopus. It's a sea animal. One that lives in the sea, underwater. It has long tentacles and a big head; all its body is gooey, like jello. Its skin is pink colored, with some redness in it too. The octopus doesn't have a sound. It lacks vocal ability like other animals. Most sea creatures don't have vocal ability in them.”

Cody listens with full attention.

“Then we have the Pig. They are very fat, small, and cute animals; their skin is pink, and they make a sound of Oink! Oink!” his mother mimicked.

Cody gets super excited and starts standing on his chair and jumps on it, laughing, mimicking the pig sounds. His mother is a bit surprised, but sees that he likes it.

“Do you like the pig sound? It does have a funny tone to it.” she said happily.

“Yes! Pig is the best friend ever.” Cody loudly said.

“best friend? Well, I don't know about that Cody. Dogs, on the other hand, are man's best friend. Like our dog Max.”

Cody is hyper-excited, making pig noises and dancing around. His mother doesn't fully understand why pigs excite him so much.

Cody calmed down after a while. He then sits back down and his ready to continue.

“Teach me more about pigs' mum! I want to know everything about them!” Cody said with playful eyes.

His mother simply smiled back at him and continued her teaching. For a few hours, they learned about everything possible about pigs and some other things.

At around 9 PM, when this is the time Cody usually goes to sleep, he stayed up in his bed thinking about Pinky. It was raining outside, and there were thunders. He wanted to go see him so badly. He

just couldn't be patient to wait for tomorrow. Cody got out of bed, put on a warm coat, and went out of his room to the corridor. As he walks silently, he tries not to wake his parents up, but oh dear... his parents are not in their room.

"Where are they?" Cody wondered to himself.

He heard noises coming from downstairs. His parents are still awake. He walks a few steps down and peeks between the banisters. He sees his dad reading a newspaper, and his mum is doing the dishes. Cody dog, Max, sees him and comes up to him. Cody moves back to the corridor to hide, so Max won't draw attention. Max comes to Cody and starts playing with him. But Cody tries to send him back.

"Go back, Max, I have no time to play." Cody whispered firmly.

Max wasn't listening. He just wanted to keep playing. As Cody continued to try to keep Max away so he could go see Pinky, suddenly, his dad called Max.

"Max! Where'd you go, boy?!" his dad called.

"Shush, you'll wake Cody. Lower your voice," his mum said in a hushed tone.

Max heard the call and left downstairs. Cody was relieved. He couldn't go from here. So he would try from his room. He went back inside and closed the door. He then opened his window and climbed out. Cody is a bit scared. The roof is very slippery, and its angle is aimed down. The view was scary as Cody looked down at the ground. The ground seems distant. Cody felt a chill in the back of his head; it felt a bit tickling, yet uncomfortable. He was frozen in place, but soon he regained courage.

"I will not stop. Pinky needs me. I will go see him!" Cody said courageously.

He gripped the roof tiles and gently slid down the roof. Everything was going well. Until Cody loses his grip and starts to slide down very fast. Everything happened so fast, Cody's heart started pounding like a drum. The edge is near, Cody must act fast.

Right at the very end..... Cody grabbed the antenna.

Back in the house, his mother is watching TV after she finishes with the dishes, but the TV starts to glitch due to the antenna. His mother is confused and thinks that the antenna should be checked.

“Honey, the TV is having problems. Can you go check the antenna?”

“Alright, I’ll go take a look.”

When his dad came outside, he looked up at the roof, and what he found was shocking.

The antenna broke, but it is unclear how.

“Honey! The antenna broke! I gotta call a repairman tomorrow!”

His dad was looking at the roof, inspecting the antenna, and the damage. Cody was hiding behind some bushes. After a while, his dad went back inside. Cody quickly moved to the stables.

He went inside and walked over to Pinky's pen. He saw Pinky was scared and shaking. Probably from the storm outside. Cody gently sat down with him. He put Pinky on his lap and gently rubbed his back. Pinky seemed to calm down; he felt comfortable and safe in Cody's arms.

Cody didn’t leave that night. He stayed in the stables with Pinky until morning came.

In the early morning at 6 AM, this is the time his dad comes to the stables to feed the horses. Cody usually gets up at 7 AM, so his dad still thinks his asleep at the house. Pinky wakes up to the sound of the stable door opening, and he quickly runs to into the hay. Cody is still asleep, unaware that his dad is approaching and Pinky is gone.

One of the horses makes a loud sound that wakes Cody up. He notices Pinky is gone, and his dad is in the stables. He must act fast, so his dad won’t discover him. Cody silently exits the pen where Pinky is and goes to another one. He unlocks the pen and keeps the pen door slightly open. The horse inside goes out of the pen and starts to speed out of the stables, bursting the stable doors open. Cody's dad is confused and alarmed as he is feeding another horse when he hears the thuds of the horse's feet and the burst-open doors. He quickly rushes out after the horse, trying to catch it. Cody finds the opportunity to get back to the house unseen.

His mum goes outside to help catch the horse, while Cody takes the chance to enter back inside the house and to his room. He takes off his coat and gets into bed, pretending he's still asleep. A few minutes later, his parents caught the horse and returned it to the stables.

“How did it get out?” his mother asked, confused.

“I have no idea. The lock must have been free somehow.” his dad said, confused also.

He checks the lock and sees everything is fine, nothing is broken or missing.

“What could have happened?” he wondered.

They leave the stables and return to the house to begin the day. Cody's mother comes upstairs to his room to wake him up. His dad is doing some work in the field.

His mum enters his room and sits by Cody. Cody still pretends his asleep. His mother kisses him on the forehead and whispers to him, “Cody, it’s time to wake up.”

He gently opens his eyes and looks at his mother. He smiles, she smiles back.

“I’m up, mummy.” he said to her gently.

“Okay, go brush your teeth and let’s get ready for today.”

Cody got up and got dressed, he brushed his teeth and went downstairs to sit by the table. This became Cody's routine for a few weeks. He would go whenever he could after meals to see Pinky and help around the farm. Sometimes at night would sneak again to spend time with Pinky.

There was a festival event at the nearby town coming in a few days. This is something that happens every year. Cody liked the festival, especially the corn dogs. But this year, Cody did not wish to go.

In the morning, when Cody went to sit for breakfast, he said to his mother that he didn’t want to go to the festival this year.

His parents were surprised at this rejection.

“Cody, what’s wrong? You love the festival.” his mother asked, concerned.

“I just don’t feel like going this year, Mum.” he responded sadly, looking down.

His dad thought something is off. Cody has been acting very peculiar in the last couple of weeks.

After breakfast, he went to Cody's room and looked around for anything strange. He found a lot of drawings of pigs and Cody's coat on the floor. He picked it up and saw traces of straw bedding on it.

“Has Cody been sneaking into the stable? But why?”

He went back outside and went to the stable. He started to search around the place. As he reached Pinky's pen, he saw the huge mountain of hay.

He got closer, and Pinky was alerted but remained hidden and quiet. He stood just inches away from him. His dad notices leftovers of fruit on the ground. He bends down to check it out closely. Pinky was about to be discovered.

Just then.... Cody walked in, rushing, breathing heavily.

“Dad, come quick. There is a problem in the chicken hen-house.” Cody said hastily.

His dad quickly leaves for the chicken hen-house to check what is wrong. Pinky has not been discovered. Cody breathes in relief. Cody saw his dad going to the stable. Fearing he might discover Pinky, he went to the chicken hen-house, and broke one of the hinges door that let all the chickens run out freely.

His parents are trying to catch all the chickens as they run around like crazy. Cody found it a little funny to see his parents running around chasing the chickens. He went outside to help his parents catch them. This took a lot of energy and time. But eventually, they managed to control the breakout.

Cody and his mother sit on the porch and rest. His dad checks how they got out in the first place. He noticed the broken hinge.

“Ha! The hinge is broken. Well, I’m gonna have to fix that.”

“Do it quickly! I’m going to make lunch ready. Cody, would you like to help me?”

“Okay!” Cody responded exhaustedly.

Cody and his mother went back into the house to prepare lunch. His dad was fixing the hen-house. Cody is helping his mother. He is very tired after all this chicken chasing. But there is work to be done.

“Cody, after lunch, you can go rest. Your father and I will take care of the rest of the chores.” she said, her voice soft and reassuring.

“Thanks, mum. Today was a hard day.” he responded tiredly.

“Yes, baby. Work on the farm is a lot of responsibility. We must take care of the animals.” she said.

“Yes, mum. I will take care of him.” he blurred out.

“Him? Who is he?”

“Nothing. I.....I mean, I would take care of them, too. Just like you and dad.” he said hesitantly.

The next day, Cody woke up as usual to do his duties. But he forgot that today is the festival and his parents were getting ready to go there. Cody went downstairs after getting ready for breakfast, and he found his parents were packing stuff for the festival.

“Mum, Dad, what are you doing?”

“It’s the festival today, son. Have you forgotten?” his dad said with joy in his voice.

“Oh, I might have forgotten. Could we possibly stay home today? I don’t feel like going.” Cody said sadly, his eyes were almost watery.

“Son, this is tradition in the family to go to the festival. We go there each year. What's the sudden change?!” his father responded seriously.

“huh.....nothing. I just want to stay home.”

Cody knew he had no choice. It's been a tradition to go there, and Cody never missed one. The sudden refusal to go might look suspicious to his parents. He eventually decided to get it over with. But Cody was worried about Pinky. Who would feed him? They're gonna be there for the whole day. The day before, they always prepare extra food and water for the animals. Making sure they have enough for the whole day.

His parents loaded the car, and Cody went to the kitchen and grabbed some fruit and ham. He put it in the pack, but then, before he could go to the stables, his dad walked in and rushed Cody to hurry and get in the car. Cody quickly hid the pack behind his back and tried to come up with an excuse. But he had no excuse to come up with, he had to think fast.

“Okay, Dad, can you give me a few minutes?” he said nervously.

“What is that you got there behind your back?” his dad asked suspiciously.

“Nothing, Dad.”

“Show me what it is, son.”

Cody revealed the pack, and his dad opened it.

“What's this? You taking those with you to the festival?”

“Uh....huh.....I....I want to give those to the horses before we leave. They must have something to eat for the day.”

“Son, we already took care of that. You know that yesterday we set up everything for the animals. There is nothing to worry about.”

“ye....yes....I know. Can I at least just give it to them before we leave? I had already packed those.”

“No son. The horses are fine, besides horses don’t eat ham son.”

His dad removed the food and gave the pack back to Cody. They then went to the car and drove to the festival.

During the entire drive, Cody was wandering in his mind, thinking constantly about Pinky. Worried if he’s okay. His mother glanced at him from the front seat through the rear-view mirror and saw him looking out the window, sad. Seemed like someone who lost his pet.

“Cody, are you okay?” his mother gently asked.

Cody didn’t respond; he just kept staring out the window, watching as the sunlight faded behind a slow drift of gray clouds.

“Cody!” his mother said in a firmer, more insistent tone, her voice raised just enough to break through the silence.

“Yes, mum?” he responded softly.

“Are you alright, sweetie?”

“Yes. I’m just tired.”

His mother was a bit worried; she thought maybe they should skip the festival today.

“Honey, should we cancel the festival and go back? Cody doesn’t seem well. He might be sick.” she said in a hushed, concerned voice.

His Dad looked at the mirror and then back at his wife.

“He will be fine. His probably worried about the horses. I caught him trying to sneak food to them.”

“Really? Were you harsh on him?”

“No, of course not. I told him it’s already taken care of, and that horses don’t eat what he tried to bring them. Can you believe it? He tried to bring ham to the horses.”

“His a little boy, he doesn’t understand it yet.”

“Well, the boy must learn it at some point, otherwise he might hurt the animals by doing the wrong thing.”

They continued their conversation. Cody still dwells in his thoughts. Thinking about how Pinky would love the festival. The a massive food and games to play there. He only wished Pinky weren’t so shy with people.

They arrived at the festival, and Cody's mum tried to cheer him up. She got him his favorite food, a corn dog, but he didn’t feel hungry. She took him to his favorite ride, the ferry, but still Cody didn’t show any signs of having a great time. It was hopeless to try.

His mother sat with him on a bench overlooking the open field.

“Cody, what’s wrong?” she asked sadly.

“Nothing, mum, I’m fine.”

“You don’t look happy. You not enjoying the festival?”

“I just want to go home.” Cody said. staring at the grass.

His dad was hanging out with some of his buddies at the parking lot in an old pickup truck. They are drinking beer, chatting, and laughing. They also own farms around the county. Some even hold other family businesses that were inherited by them through generations. One was Buck, who owned a processing plant. The other was Duke, who owned a farm.

Cody only saw his dad meeting up with his friends when they arrived, and then he went inside with his mother, while his dad stayed with his friends.

Cody's mother approached them.

“Honey, I think it’s time we go. Cody is not feeling well.”

“Already? We've only been here a few hours. We still have plenty of time.”

“Are you drunk?”

He sips from his beer.

“Not yet... But getting there.” he said, laughing.

“That’s enough! Cody is not well, we should head home now!” she said in a high-pitched voice.

“Just a couple more beers.”

“NO! Let’s go now!”

“Man, your lady never let you do any fun things.” Buck said, laughing.

“That’s marriage for you, buddy.” he takes a sip of his beer.

“Never get married... Ever!”

Cody's mum gets upset when his dad is drinking with his buddies. Each year, she and Cody enjoy the festival, while his dad gets drunk with his buddies.

His dad, half drunk, was walking funny towards the car. Cody waits there with his mother. His dad gets in the passenger seat, and his mother gets in the driver's seat. Cody always knew his dad was the one driving. It’s only when they go to the festival, his mum is driving the way back.

“Dad must be tired from helping around at the festival.” Cody thought to himself.

Cody never saw his dad actually working there. His mother always told him to wait by the ferry. Cody just sat there and watched his favorite ride as people went up up up up and then down down down.

On their way home, Dad was sleeping, and Cody couldn't wait to get home so he could check up on Pinky. He hoped he was okay. He hoped he would be able to sneak some food to him.

They arrived home, and his mum helped his dad get out of the car and walk him into the house. But what they found inside was something they didn't expect to see.

Pinky was in the house, and he thrashed the kitchen and ate all the fruits. Chairs were knocked to the floor, and mud smudges streaked the floor and cabinets. The place was a mess.

"OH MY LORD, how this pig got in here?!" his dad yelled.

"Oink, Oink" was all Pinky said.

"Pinky!" Cody shouted.

"Pinky? You know this piglet, Cody?!" his dad said furiously.

"His my friend. Please don't scare him!"

"So that's the reason you wanted to get home so much?!" his mother said, shocked.

"Y..... Y-yes." he responded shamelessly.

His mother looked at him, seeing how much Cody cared for the piglet.

"For how long has this been going on?"

"A few weeks, Mum."

"Where were you hiding him?"

"In the stables, I made him a nice place there."

She told Cody to take the piglet back to the stables and wait for her there. She helped his dad get upstairs and put him to bed. He was drunk and not in a good mood.

She then went to the stables, and Cody was there getting Pinky comfortable.

“Cody, why haven’t you told us about your little friend here?”

“he was scared. I wanted to, but Pinky was scared to meet new people. He doesn’t fear me, though. We are good friends, Mum.” he said joyfully.

“I can see that.” she looked at how happy Cody was with his new friend, but thought she should tell him something. No, that will be for another time. She doesn’t want to ruin Cody's happiness; she could figure something out.

“Okay, Cody, I don’t know what your father will think of keeping a piglet as a pet, but he most likely won’t agree to this. I will try to talk to him to let you keep him. Hopefully he will forget about today’s incident because his not... well... not feeling well.”

“Thanks, mum.”

“But this won’t come easy, young man. You're gonna have to clean up the mess your little friend made in our kitchen.”

“Okay, mum. I will tell Pinky not to do this again.”

“but pigs don’t... uh.... Sure... you tell him sweetie.” She hesitated.

“Now say good night to your little friend and let’s go clean the kitchen before your dad gets mad again.”

Cody said goodbye to Pinky for the night and went to help his mother clean the kitchen.

The next morning, Cody's dad woke up with a bad headache.

“HAAA, my head... W-wh... What happened?” he said to himself, dizzy and in pain.

His dad thought yesterday was a dream. He got up to wash his face and then went down to the kitchen. It was cleaned.

He went out to start his daily routine. Usually, he starts in the field with his tractor. But today he decided he would do it later as his head was still dizzy from last night's drinking. So he went to the stables to take care of the horses. When he entered, he heard a noise coming from the end of the stables. He walked in closer, and suddenly his wife came into view.

"Honey, you awake!" she said out loud.

"What are you doing here?"

"You were not feeling well last night. So I let you rest and do what needed to be done."

"Oh, I see. Well... thanks, but I'm fine now. I can work."

Fearing he must discover Pinky and Cody, she tried to take him outside so he wouldn't find them in here.

"Let me handle it. You can start in the field as you always do."

"I can't drive right now. My mind is still a bit dizzy. But it will pass. I just need to pass the time working."

"Well, why won't you go inside the house and let me make you a cup of tea. You should start the day with a good warm cup of tea, Honey."

"Hmmm, you may be right. I would like a cup of tea. My head is still killing me."

"Alright, let's go then."

"Let me finish up here first, and then I will join you." his dad said, insisting.

"Don't worry about it. I'll tell Cody to take care of it."

“Where is Cody anyway?”

“Probably still asleep. Or around the house playing somewhere.”

“I had this terrible dream of a piglet trashing our kitchen. It felt so real.” he said with confused eyes.

“You just still dizzy from last night. You had more drinks than you should have.”

The parents left the stables and went into the house. Cody got up from hiding. Pinky got food that should last for the rest of the day, and a fresh, warm blanket. Cody then went to feed the horses as his mother requested. After that, he went back to the house for breakfast, acting casually as if nothing had happened.

Cody sat down and waited for his breakfast while his dad drank his tea and observed him.

“Cody, where were you?”

“I was at the chicken hen-house, Dad.”

“I see. Well, you know you're not supposed to wander off without our permission, son. Especially this early.”

“Sorry, Dad, I won't wander off again.”

“You've been acting weird a lot lately. What is up with you, son?”

“Nothing, Dad.”

“Cody!” his father said with a focused, serious look.

“Leave the boy alone, Honey. His just a kid,” his mother responded harshly.

“Oh, Cody, I need you to go and feed the horses. Your dad is not feeling very well. Please do it quickly and come back for breakfast.”

“Okay, mum.”

Right before Cody was about to leave, his dad intervened.

“No! I’ll do it. I’m feeling better now.”

“Honey, it’s okay. Cody can take care of it.”

“No, I can handle it. Let the boy eat.”

With that, his dad went out to the stables. Cody could only sit and wait as his mother kept cooking.

When his dad was out there, He saw that the horses already had food given to them. He was confused. He then got closer to where Pinky is hiding. He entered the pen and stood on the straw bedding; his footsteps were heard silently, like a horror movie. He stood by the haystack right in front of it. He bends down and tries to look inside.

Then... THUD!!! Pinky burst through the haystack and pushed Dad to the ground, and started running like crazy, snorting frantically.

“WHOA! What the hell!” Dad panicked and fell to the ground.

He regains his balance and got up.

He started chasing Pinky, trying to catch him. Cody and his mother heard the commotion and left the house in a hurry to see what was happening.

They saw Pinky running in the open, sprinting towards Cody. He quickly went to his feet and lay down there. His father falls behind, catching his breath.

“CODY! What did you do, hide a pig in the stable? You're in big trouble, young man!” his father said furiously.

His mother stepped in to calm him down.

“Calm down! Cody found himself a friend. He was only trying to help him.”

“What the hell are you on about, woman!? The boy hid a pig in the stables. He was sneaking outside and giving it food.”

“Please, dad....” Cody blurred out.

“QUIET! You grounded son! Now go to your room. This pig is coming with me. It ain't staying here!”

Cody went into the house crying, sad, and depressed. His mother grabbed Pinky, who tried to follow him.

“Honey, please! Let's just talk about it...”

“There is nothing to talk about. The boy lied to me, and you were in it. For how long have you known about this?!”

“I only found out yesterday.”

“Look, this piglet has something good with our son. He made him happy. Don't you want your son to be happy?”

“Woman, this is not going to work, and you know it. So why won't you stop fucking with my authority and do as I say? I'm doing this for Cody.”

“Please... you can't.”

“This has to be done!”

When the conversation ended, Cody's father picks up Pinky, who tries to escape from his grip. Pinky is thrashing in his arms and squealing loudly. He takes him to his truck, puts him inside a cage, and drives away.

Cody from his window, watching his dad drive Pinky away. He is devastated. He goes to his bed and cries loudly. His mother is coming up to check on him.

"Cody? Are you okay, sweetie?" his mother was knocking on the door trying to get in, but it was locked.

"Go away, mum!" Cody shouted with tears flowing from his eyes.

"Cody, please open the door! I promise I will speak to your dad, and we will get Pinky back!"

Cody doesn't respond anymore; he just cries himself to sleep.

A few hours later, his dad returned, but without Pinky. Cody stayed in his room for the rest of the day, not even going out to eat. His mother came up a few times and left some for him, but he refused to accept it.

"Are you happy now?! Cody doesn't get out of his room all day!"

"The boy will learn I did it for his own good. Let me talk to him."

His father went upstairs, once standing outside his room, he saw a tray of food his mother had left for him, some already gotten cold and dry.

"Cody! I know you're upset, son, but this is for your own good. You're too young to grow a pet."

"Max is a pet dad!"

"Yes, but Max is also a guard dog. His an animal with discipline and can do more than just being a pet. He is essential to the family."

“I don’t believe you! Pinky is my friend, he can do whatever Max can do!”

“Huh... sure, son. I’m sure it can, but your little friend can’t stay here. We..... huh.... We... we don’t have the resources or place to take care of a pig here... But don’t worry. I sent him to a better place. He will be happy there.”

Cody suddenly opens the door.

“Where?”

“His in a good place, son. His with more of his kind and his gonna have a great time there.”

His dad knelt in front of Cody, his arm reached out to his shoulder, and slowly caressed him.

“We can’t take care of another pet here, son. I hope you understand.”

“Can I go visit him?”

“huh... I’m sure I can arrange something, but for now, let your little friend get used to the new place. If we go there and surprise it, it might get uncomfortable with its new friends. it might want to come with us back home.”

“Well, shouldn’t we take him then if he wants to?”

“No, son, I told you we can’t take care of it here. This can complicate things a bit.”

“But, I will speak with the guy who takes care of your little friend. This could take some time, though, alright?”

“But remember that it’s best to let your friend be with its kind. We shouldn’t separate it from the rest... It’s best to just... let it go.”

“Okay, Dad! I understand.”

“Good! Now, why won’t you take this tray back to your mother and have her make you a new one? This one is already cold and dry. You must eat.”

Cody took the tray and went downstairs to the kitchen, where his mother started cooking dinner. He put it on the table and sat down.

“Cody! You hungry, baby?”

“Yes, Mum. I am!”

“Okay! Food is almost ready!”

Cody's mother was happy he finally came out of his room. She hoped this would all be behind them soon. They all sat down and ate dinner, chatted, watched some TV, and then it was time to go to bed and prepare for tomorrow.

The next day went out as any other normal day. His parents are doing their duties around the farm, while Cody helps them.

Cody, every break went to the stable to sit in the pen where Pinky was, thinking about him. Wondering when he will get to see him.

Time went by. A day, a week, a month. Cody started to lose his patience.

“Dad, when I get to see Pinky?” “Dad, when I get to see Pinky?” “Dad, when I get to see Pinky?” “Dad, when I get to see Pinky?” “Dad, when I get to see Pinky?” “Dad, when I get to see Pinky?”

This went on and on and on each day. Cody was persistent and wouldn’t quit.

“Son! Quit it! You won’t get to see it if you keep bothering me every time asking about it!”

“BUT YOU PROMISED DAD!” he shouted

“DON’T RAISE YOUR VOICE AT ME, YOUNG MAN!!!”

“Now go to your room and stay there!”

Cody stormed to his room, angry and frustrated. He just couldn't take it anymore. He decided that if his dad won't let him see Pinky, he would go look for him himself.

But there was a problem, Cody didn't know where Pinky was taken. It was hopeless, but he would try something.

The next day, Cody was grounded to his room; he couldn't leave to help on the farm or play outside. He would just stay in his room and only come out for meals. His mother came to his room to call him for breakfast, and Cody then took the opportunity to ask her where Dad took Pinky.

“Mum, where did Dad take Pinky?”

“I don't know, my dear, but I'm sure Pinky is fine.”

“He won't let me go see him, not even tell me where he is.”

“Your dad is just an old crusty man. Don't take it too seriously.”

Cody's plan failed. His mother doesn't know anything. They went down to the kitchen and sat down for breakfast.

The room was silent, there was no chatter, only the sound of forks and glass water could be heard. It was not awkward; it was more eerie. Tension could be felt flowing in the air. A warm chill crawls up Cody's spine.

When they were done, Cody was on his way back to his room when suddenly, he saw the mail lying on the dresser in the living room. Without anyone watching, he quickly took a look at them and saw a few from dad's friends. One was from Duke, who owned a farm too, not far from here. Cody has never been there. The other was from Buck, who owned a processing plant; Cody had also never been there.

Cody waited for his dad to go outside back to work, so that he could go ask his mother about these people. When he left, Cody went to the kitchen, where his mother was doing the dishes.

“Mum, what do dad friends do?”

“What do you mean, Cody? Why do you ask?”

“I... well... I just wanna learn some new things, Mum.”

“Well, Cody, your dad has a lot of friends who do different things. I barely know some of them.”

“Do some own a farm like us?”

“Yes, there are Travis, Wade, and Duke.”

“What animals do they have there?”

“Huh, pretty much the same we do. It’s common to have chickens, cows, and sheep.”

“Actually, I think Duke might have a pig pen. Ha... I’m not so sure myself.”

Cody got what he wanted; he was ready to act.

“I see. Thanks, mum.”

“Mum, can you teach me maps today? I would like to learn about maps.”

“Sure. Let me finish up here, and I will come upstairs and teach you.”

When they finished talking, Cody went back to his room and waited for his mother to come and teach him. She arrived and brought a big map of the region. With names of roads and streets. She showed him the other farm locations, including Duke, and their farm location. Cody got very interested in maps, for it would lead him closer to Pinky. He listened very closely to everything his mother taught him.

Later that night, Cody prepared stuff for his journey. He would go at noon after lunch, which would give him enough time to be out without anyone noticing until dinner time, and there would still be daylight.

The next morning has arrived, the sun is rising, it's a bright day, no clouds or signs of coming rain. Cody is waking up and getting ready; he is a bit uneasy about the coming day, for it will be his first time going outside of the farm area alone.

After lunch, Cody went to his room and grabbed his pack and went downstairs. His mother was still doing the dishes as usual, so he took the opportunity to sneak out from the front door. His dad was working in the field, so he was busy. Cody went ahead to the farm dirt road and followed it all the way to the main road. From there, he continued toward Duke's farm. Along with his pack, food, and water. Cody also carried the map his mother used to teach him yesterday. He used the map with what he learned to navigate his way to Duke Farm. But the journey would not be easy for a little boy in the open world; he has still much to learn.

For about 20 minutes on the road, Cody sees a farm appearing in view, and he gets closer to see if he has arrived at the right place. Cody sees a man coming out of a barn; he recognizes him from the festival, it's him, it's Duke.

He arrived at the correct place; now it's time to search for Pinky. Cody slowly sneaks closer to the barn and enters. He looks around the area, but there is nothing in there; there are just stacks of hay, metal chains hanging down, and an old, broken tractor in there. Cody exits and continues to search around the farm area. He then hears a noise coming nearby, "Oink! Oink!"

"Pinky!!" he thought to himself.

Cody quickly rushes to where the noise is coming from. He gets to a brick enclosure that is locked tight with a lock. There must be a key for it. Cody looks around and sees a shed not far from it. He goes there, and it's also locked, but he spots a small crack in it at the bottom. The old shed is so old, dirty, and looks like it's about to be torn apart. Cody thought about how Pinky had managed to get into their shed, digging his way in just like his mother had taught him pigs were capable of. Cody knelt and started digging fast, almost like a pig. He crawls inside and searches for the key. He finds a chain of it, so he takes it and goes back to the enclosure. He now tries every key in the lock to open it. Tries one, fails, tries the second, fails, tries the third, fails. Cody is slowly getting frustrated, the noises inside are getting louder, and his struggling with the keys, worried he might get discovered.

Finally, the last key in the chain managed to unlock the door. Cody gently opens the enclosure door and enters, and what he sees shocks him.

Dozens of pigs in pens, big and small. All are very noisy and filthy. He looks over to every pen and tries to see if Pinky is among them, but it's hard to tell, they all look alike, and their sizes are different. Pinky was small but fat. Quite confusing for Cody to figure it out.

"Pinky! Pinky! Pinky!" he calls for him.

The noises only get louder that they send a ringing down Cody's ears. Suddenly, Cody hears someone coming towards the enclosure. It must be Duke who heard the loud noises. Cody has no time; he has to leave. Unable to find Pinky and afraid he might be discovered, he left in a hurry, and he closed the door but forgot to lock it.

Cody sneaked out back to the main road and headed home. Duke got to the enclosure after hearing the loud noise and saw the lock open, no signs of forced entry or breaking in, and the keys were on it too. He thought he might have forgotten them here, but that's impossible; he always places the keys in the shed. He locked the enclosure, put the keys back in the shed, and searched around the farm for any intruders. Luckily, Cody got away, and Duke found nothing, only a strange hole under his shed, but Duke thought it was nothing. The shed is old; the ground must be weak around it. He should replace it.

Cody went back home; his parents were still busy, so he could sneak back into the house and wait till dinner.

Cody was devastated. He thought he would find Pinky, but he didn't; he started crying and thinking about Pinky. He wondered if Pinky was thinking about him and the time they had together, even if it was for a short period of time.

Cody wouldn't give up; he would try again. Pinky must have been sent to Buck's place. He would go there to check it out. The only thing left is to find Buck's place.

"MUM!" he yelled.

"What is it, Cody?" she rushes up the stairs into Cody's room.

"Could you teach me more about maps?"

“Right now? We already learned about it yesterday. Shouldn’t we learn something else?”

“Please! Just a little bit more.”

She agreed. Cody asked about Buck’s place, and his mother showed him where it’s located. Buck’s place was a bit far away. It would be a great challenge to get there.

The next day, Cody got ready again, packed some extra food and water. It was snowing outside, so Cody took his coat with him. Traveling in this cold would be very challenging. Cody went downstairs to sneak outside again, when suddenly his dad walked in and spoke to his mother. He was saying he was heading to Buck’s place to get some business done.

“This is perfect.” Cody thought to himself.

He could sneak into his dad’s truck and ride along. Cody waited for a clear exit, then he went out and got into the back of his dad’s truck. He hid under the cover of blankets that were in there and some tools. Cody also saw big metal jaws, sharp as swords; they looked like giant mouths.

A few minutes later, his dad got into the truck and drove to Buck’s place. Cody, peeking through, looked up from where he was lying and saw the cloudy sky in gray. It made him feel quite sad; he wasn’t sure why. It was like something dark was hidden among the skies.

The truck stops; they arrived at Buck’s place. Cody covered himself and hid. His father came to the back and unloaded the big metal mouths. Buck came and started talking to him.

“So, these are the traps?”

“Sure is, you can catch anything with this. Perfect for bears.”

“Sweet, let’s go to my house, and I’ll get your payment.”

They walked away, Cody slowly rose from the covers, and peeked through the side of the truck. The coast was clear, it’s time to move.

Buck's place looked a bit different; he didn't have a barn or stable anywhere like on their farm. Instead, a big building was before him. Cody went there and heard noises that rang loudly in his ears. It was a sharp, piercing noise that felt like knives in his ears.

Cody found an open bay door. When he got there, the floor was wet with red water.

"Does Buck make strawberry juice here?" Cody thought.

The smell was strong and had an aroma of death. Cody steps in closer. His steps were gentle in the puddle of red water, and he went deeper into the building.

THEN! He saw it..... Bodies, hundreds of bodies of pigs, all torn apart and hanging from hooks. Blood covered the floor, guts spilled from the headless carcasses, and machines were working, grinding the meaty flesh. Metal chains and hooks hang from the ceiling, instruments of death on large workbenches with blood splatter on them. The sound of the machines was unbearable, flesh torn and bones crushing. Cody started crying; his ears were exploding with sharp stabs of noise. He covered his ears, but the sound was too powerful.

Unable to look at the horror in front of him, Cody turns and starts to run, only to then fall to the floor and be covered in blood and guts.

"NO!" His terrified. His scared. His traumatized. This ain't no place for a fucking kid.

He gets up and runs out with all his strength, only to then bump into his father.

"CODY!"

He grabbed Cody in his arms, seeing him covered in blood, his father thought the worst.

"DID SOMEONE ATTACK YOU, SON!?"

Cody couldn't answer; he just stood there in his father's arms, crying. Shaking.

Buck went inside to check if there was anyone inside, while his father checked for wounds.

"SON! LOOK AT ME! WHAT ARE YOU DOING HERE!? THIS AIN'T A PLACE FOR A KID!"

Still no answer from Cody. His father saw no physical wounds. Cody was fine... Physically.

Buck came back.

“There’s no one in here!”

“I’m gonna take him home!” his dad said, voice trembling, eyes wide.

On their way home, his father was driving wildly while trying to talk to Cody.

“SON! Are you alright!?”

“Come on, boy! Talk to me!”

“Son of a bitch!” HONK! HONK! His father blasts the horn at other drivers.

“GET OUT THE FUCKING WAY!”

They finally arrived home, and his father quickly picked Cody up and got into the house. Cody was awake but paralyzed and couldn’t seem to move or talk. He put Cody onto the couch in the living room, and his mother ran quickly to him.

“WHAT HAPPENED?!”

“he was found in the slaughterhouse. I have no idea how he got there. Must have snuck into my truck this morning.”

“ARE YOU CRAZY! THE SLAUGHTERHOUSE! His covered in blood, what happened in there?!”

“his okay! There are no wounds on him! He just slipped or something! Just clean the damn boy woman!!!”

His mother went and got a wet towel and cleaned him up. She took his bloody coat off and took him up to the shower. She carefully cleaned him, washed him nice and clean, just like when he was a baby..... Still her baby.

Later on, she dressed Cody in new clothes and put him in his bed. She sat by him and watched him closely; Meanwhile, his father called a doctor.

The doctor arrived an hour later and checked Cody.

“The boy is fine! His just in shock. He should be fine soon.” the doctor calmly said.

Cody’s mother stayed with him the whole day. He wasn’t eating or speaking at all.

A new day emerged, Cody was sleeping, and his mother was lying by his bed, laying her head next to him.

He awoke.

“Mum?”

She awakes.

“Yes, sweetie! Are you feeling better?!”

Cody nods in approval, but doesn’t say anything else.

“Cody....I-I.....”

She tries to speak, but thinks it’s too early yet for that, so she saves that for later.

“Let’s go get some breakfast, shall we?”

Cody nods in approval and gets out of bed.

Everything seems to go as normal. Nobody says a word; they sit by the table and eat. No chatter. No joy.

After breakfast, Cody went back to his room and stayed there for the whole day. His mother comes to his room once and a while to stay with him. Although she wants to tell him something, she can't. She believes it will only do more harm than good. So she just stays with him and tries to distract him with other things. Coloring books, reading, and playing games with him. Cody wasn't really showing interest.

A few days go by like this, but about a week later, Cody slowly starts to show signs of interest. He plays more, reads, and draws.

His mother avoids speaking or showing anything related to pigs, fearing letting him think about his close friend he had. She herself doesn't know what happened to Pinky. She decided to go ask her husband.

Later that night, when Cody was asleep, she and her husband were in the living room.

"Honey! Where did you take Cody, little piglet?"

"I sold him."

"To whom?"

"Does it matter?"

"I just thought we might get him back; he could make Cody feel better."

"Woman, that piglet is not supposed to be here or be taken care of by a kid!"

"I helped the boy by taking it away! No kid should take this responsibility! Not at this age!"

"Can you at least make contact and see if you can get him back?"

"It's not coming back!"

Upset by her husband's stubbornness and refusing to help, she went to Cody's room and lay beside him, hugging him closely. She was not sleeping with her husband tonight.

The next morning, it started raining. The day has already begun with a dark shadow of the skies looming over the farm.

Cody and his mother woke up, and his mother thought this was the time to tell him.

“Cody! There is something I need to tell you!”

“I-I.....it's.....” she sighs, unable to speak clearly, fearing she will upset her son and destroy his childhood.

But then.....

“It's okay, mum! We all have to grow at some point.”

He looked out at the rain.

“That's just how..... The world works.”

END